

The Noble Great Vehicle Sūtra Called the King Who Arrays the Qualities of All Phenomena

Āryasarvadharmaguṇavyūharāja nāma Mahāyānasūtra · Toh 114 · Derge Kangyur
འཕགས་པ་ཆས་ཐམས་ཅད་ཀྱི་ཉན་བཀའ་པའི་རྒྱ་པོ་ཞེས་བརྒྱུ་ཐག་པ་ཆེ་པའི་མཛན།

Toh 114 in the Kangyur is a Mahāyāna sūtra known in Sanskrit as the Ārya Sarvadharmaguṇavyūharāja and in Tibetan as the Chö tamché kyi yönten köpé gyalpo, rendered in English as the Noble Great Vehicle Sūtra Called the King Who Arrays the Qualities of All Phenomena. It belongs to the general class of Mahāyāna sūtras and is set in Rājagṛha, where the Buddha addresses a vast assembly of monks and bodhisattvas, each accomplished in dhāraṇī and devoted to the welfare of all beings. The text's title suggests a concern with the display and enumeration of the qualities inherent in all phenomena, a theme characteristic of sūtras that illuminate the nature of reality through the lens of Mahāyāna doctrine. As with many sūtras of its kind, it opens with the standard proclamation of the teaching's direct transmission through the words "Thus did I hear," situating it firmly within the received scriptural tradition of the Buddha's discourses.

In the language of India: Ārya Sarvadharmaguṇavyūharāja nāma Mahāyānasūtra. In the language of Tibet: The Noble Great Vehicle Sūtra Called the King Who Arrays the Qualities of All Phenomena.

Homage to all buddhas and bodhisattvas.

Thus did I hear. At one time the Blessed One was dwelling in Rājagṛha, in the Kalandaka Bamboo Grove, together with a great Saṅgha of five hundred monks in full, and with twelve hundred bodhisattvas, great beings, every one of whom had attained dhāraṇī, who beheld a wisdom free of attachment, whose sphere of activity was free of attachment, who were skilled in skillful means, whose minds were equanimous toward all three realms, who had entered into the supreme intention of benefit and compassion, and who sought only the kind of discourse that relates to the Tathāgata's teaching. These were: the bodhisattva, great being Maitreya (Loving-Kindness); the bodhisattva, great being Constant Diligence; the bodhisattva, great being Abiding in Equality; the bodhisattva, great being Immovable; the bodhisattva, great being Noble Intellect; the bodhisattva, great being Great Intellect; the bodhisattva, great being Boundless Eloquence; the bodhisattva, great being Intellect That Subdues; the bodhisattva, great being Avalokiteśvara, the Sovereign — and these twelve hundred bodhisattvas and others besides. Also

present were Śakra (Indra, lord of the gods), Brahmā, the world-guardians, the kings of the nāgas, all the lords of the rākṣasas, three hundred yakṣinīs, and others who were non-Buddhists in their conduct — wanderers, six thousand naked ascetics, seven kings of the garuḍas — all assembled together in one place.

All of them circumambulated the Tathāgata, and in order to perform the act of making offering to the Tathāgata they caused a rain of divine flowers to shower down. They caused a rain of divine sandalwood powder to shower down as well. And they sounded divine cymbals and bells in order to perform the act of making offering to the Tathāgata. All those who had fervent faith in the Tathāgata's teaching spoke with one voice, saying: "Excellent, Blessed One! Excellent, Blessed One! How wondrous is this — that the Tathāgata's teaching exhausts all afflictions. Excellent, Excellent!"

Then, at that moment, the Blessed One entered into meditative absorption in the samādhi called Dustless Victory Banner That Utterly Vanquishes All Afflictions. Through the power of that samādhi, this great earth rose and fell, and trembled, shook greatly, and shook in every part; it quaked, quaked greatly, and quaked in every part; it heaved, heaved greatly, and heaved in every part; it was disturbed, greatly disturbed, disturbed in every part; it rumbled, rumbled greatly, rumbled in every part; it resounded, resounded greatly, resounded in every part. A rain of divine sandalwood powder fell down. A rain of divine flowers fell down. A radiance of divine light arose. In this world-realm of the great trichiliocosm, all sentient beings who had been born in the lower destinies were completely liberated from those lower destinies. The abodes of the lord of the gods, the lord of the nāgas, the lord of the yakṣas, the lord of the rākṣasas, and the lord of humans — all of these were filled with brilliant light. The sound of divine cymbals rang out. Divine lights shone forth. The fragrance of divine incense arose.

Then all those assembled, having witnessed this great miraculous display, were filled with wonder and thought to themselves: "What can this be — this shining forth of these places, this appearance of such a great miracle, this trembling of the great earth, and

this great rain of flowers — whose power is this, whose blessing is it?" They fell silent all at once and said to one another: "This is the Tathāgata's power. This is the Tathāgata's miraculous display."

Then the four great kings thought to themselves: "We must go at once to where the Blessed One is, so that we may behold the Tathāgata, pay homage, make offerings, and hear the Dharma." And then the lord of the gods (Śakra, i.e. Indra), the lord of the nāgas, the lord of the yakṣas, and the lord of the rākṣasas — all of them, endowed with great miraculous power and great might — took up divine flowers: blue lotuses, red lotuses, night-blooming lotuses, white lotuses, supreme fragrances, mandārava flowers, and great mandārava flowers; and they went to where the Blessed One was dwelling in the Kalandaka Grove in the Bamboo Wood. Arriving there, they made offerings to the Blessed One and paid homage. So great was that rain of flowers that it lay covering this vast earth to the depth of one's knees.

Then all those great bodhisattvas (bodhisattvas), those great beings, circumambulated the Blessed One three times in order to hear the Dharma, and took their seats to one side. Then the great bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi, surrounded by many tens of millions of bodhisattvas and many tens of millions of gods, with many tens of millions of mantra-holders arrayed before him, came forward with great miraculous power, great might, and a great array — with flowers, incense, garlands, perfume, the sounds of music, cymbals, and the loud clashing of hand-cymbals — and made offerings to the Tathāgata together with the Saṅgha of monks and the assembly of bodhisattvas. Then at that time the bodhisattva Vyūharāja made a great offering to the Tathāgata with a divine array, the power of that array, and a great rain of flowers.

Then all those great bodhisattvas, those great beings, having witnessed that vast assembly, felt the wish to hear talk connected with the Dharma. The Blessed One, knowing the minds of those bodhisattvas with his wisdom, spoke to the bodhisattva Vyūharāja as follows: "Son of good family, go and look at this great earth." The bodhisattva Vyūharāja then looked at the great earth, and having looked, he said to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, I have looked at the great earth. Blessed One, I see that the Blessed One has created a great gathering of happiness for all sentient beings." The Blessed One declared: "Vyūharāja, sixty-four thousand living beings shall this very day receive prophecy of unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening."

Then the great bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi touched his head to the two feet of the Blessed One and said to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, gods, nāgas, yakṣas, rākṣasas, humans, wanderers, and many roaming ones are assembled here. Sugata, many sentient beings are assembled. Blessed One, this is the time to hear the Dharma. Sugata, this is the time to hear the Dharma." But the

Blessed One remained silent. The bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi beseeched the Tathāgata a second and then a third time: "Blessed One, please teach. Sugata, please teach. Please fulfill the aspirations of all sentient beings. Blessed One, for the sake of removing regret, for the healing and happiness of all sentient beings, please teach" — this is the sūtra called "The King of Arrangements, Endowed with the Qualities of All Phenomena."

exhausting all afflictions, utterly vanquishing all māras, exhausting all evil, inspiring faith in sentient beings who lack faith, pacifying the harm of famine, pacifying all illness, and averting all untimely death. I heard this from the Tathāgata Vidyutprabhā, and the very moment I heard it, all phenomena appeared to me directly, all lower realms were completely cut off, and all karmic obscurations were completely cut off — please teach what that was.

Then the Blessed One spoke these words to the bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi: "Son of good family, in a future time, in a future age, there will appear sentient beings who lack faith in my teaching and who lack full faith and confidence in the sūtras spoken by the Tathāgatas. They will say such words as: 'This is not a sūtra spoken by a Tathāgata. In this there is no karmic ripening whatsoever of the results of virtuous and non-virtuous actions.' Overwhelmed by attachment, they will not apply themselves to making offerings, nor will they make offerings to those who teach the Dharma. In this very life, many conflicts will arise for them, and later they will be boiled in the hells. Son of good family, this is like the father and mother of all the Tathāgatas — this great king among sūtras that exhausts all karma is not the time to hear it. Other tīrthikas, wanderers (parivrājakas), and many other sentient beings as well will go to the lower realms.

Son of good family, those beings will not come to have faith in this king of sūtras. With minds intoxicated by desire, they will busy themselves managing their households, and they will become addicted to plowing and trade and warfare and fighting. After death they will be boiled in the eight great hells.

Then at that time eighty thousand living beings rose from their seats, touched the feet of the Blessed One, and spoke these words: 'Blessed One, we will have faith. We will make offerings. We will proclaim it widely. We will delight in asking about it, reading it, having it recited, and reciting it ourselves. If in that future time when the Dharma has declined we are met with contempt, censure, and slander, we will endure it. Blessed One, we will repay your kindness and will not fail to repay it, and we will not let ourselves come to feel

regret. Blessed One, please teach the sūtra called The King of Arrangements Endowed with the Qualities of All Phenomena. In that future age and future time it will perform the activity of the Tathāgatas.'

Then the bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi spoke these words to the Blessed One: 'Blessed One, how should a bodhisattva, a great being, seek out a spiritual friend (kalyāṇamitra)?'

The Blessed One declared: 'Son of good family, in this matter a bodhisattva, a great being, should seek out a spiritual friend by means of four qualities: a continuous wish to attend upon the spiritual friend, having set out in diligence, thoroughly purified intention, and love of the Dharma. Endowed with these four qualities, a bodhisattva, a great being, should seek out a spiritual friend.'

The bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi asked: 'Blessed One, what should a bodhisattva who dwells in a solitary place do?'

The Blessed One declared: 'These are: completely abandoning household life, completely abandoning association with unwholesome companions, and giving away all one's possessions.'

Then the bodhisattva, the great being, the noble Avalokiteśvara addressed the Blessed One thus: 'Blessed One, I do not see anyone who, having heard this enumeration of the Dharma, would go to a lower realm. That is simply impossible. Blessed One, if one who merely hears this enumeration of the Dharma and pays homage to it possesses great miraculous power and great might, then what need is there to speak of one who copies it in writing, has it copied in writing, bears it, recites it, and makes offerings with parasols, victory banners, and pennants — and who moreover makes offerings of robes and ornaments to the Dharma teacher? Such a one is blessed by all the buddhas. Such a one has been prophesied by the Tathāgata to be reborn in the world-realm of Sukhāvatī. The Dharma teacher should be regarded as none other than a Tathāgata himself.'

The Blessed One declared: 'Son of good family, it is indeed so. Excellent! Excellent! I too shall make offerings to that Dharma teacher. I shall also prophesy that one to be reborn in the world-realm of Sukhāvatī. One who performs the service of attending upon a Tathāgata as a preceptor, and who makes offerings with flowers, incense, perfumes, garlands, unguents, robes, ornaments, parasols, victory banners, and pennants — such a one will not die an untimely death. There will be no fear from an enemy's army, no fear of harm from famine, no distress arising from one's children, and no distress

arising from one's wife, and all wishes will be fulfilled completely.

Son of good family, the arising of Tathāgatas and the hearing of this king of sūtras are alike difficult to encounter. Son of good family, whatever village, city, town, household, or hermitage is a place where this enumeration of the Dharma is practiced — that place is one upheld by the Tathāgatas.'

Then the bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi addressed the Blessed One thus: 'Blessed One, for what reason is he called Avalokiteśvara, Avalokiteśvara?'

The Blessed One declared: 'Because he looks upon, considers, satisfies, guards, and truly relieves all the world in this way, and because he is endowed with a mind of compassion, a mind of happiness, a mind of loving-kindness, and a mind of tender affection, and fulfills all wishes completely — for that reason he is called Avalokiteśvara.'

Then the bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi asked: 'Blessed One, if even the mere contemplation of the name Avalokiteśvara fulfills all wishes completely, what then need be said of those who make direct offerings to the Tathāgata, who have sincere faith in this enumeration of the Dharma, who bear it, recite it, copy it in writing, have it copied in writing, and who make great offerings of robes and ornaments — and, above all, who adorn themselves with ornaments and then copy it in writing and have it copied in writing?'

Then the bodhisattva, the great being, the noble Avalokiteśvara addressed the Blessed One thus:

"Blessed One, this enumeration of the Dharma is of great power; it performs the activity of the Tathāgatas."

The Blessed One then declared: "O son of noble family, there is a dhāraṇī called 'Victorious.' When I was still a bodhisattva, I received it from the Tathāgata Melody of the Victor, and the very moment I received it I attained the tenth ground, and many thousands of sentient beings also attained acceptance of the Dharma.

Then those bodhisattvas spoke thus: "Blessed One, please teach the great dhāraṇī."

Thereupon the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, gave voice to this dhāraṇī in tones and melody like the song of the kalavinka bird:

Tadyathā: jaya jaya, jayavaha jayavaha, khavaha, hulu hulu, padmape, avamavame, sarasaraṇe, dhiri dhiri, dhiri dhiri, devatānupālani, yuddhotāraṇe,

paracakraniparaṇi, pūraya bhagavān sarva āśān, mama sarva karmakṣāpaya, buddhādhiṣṭhānena svāhā.

"O son of noble family, this is the dhāraṇī called 'Victorious.' It exhausts all misdeeds; it multiplies wealth and grain; it repels the forces of enemy armies; it thoroughly pacifies the harm of famine; and it lengthens life. This is an enumeration of the Dharma comparable to the father and mother of all Tathāgatas.

"O son of noble family, whoever bows down before this enumeration of the Dharma and the words of the dhāraṇī mantra and makes offerings with completely pure intention — copying it in writing, having it copied in writing, making great offerings and honouring those who teach the Dharma — for that person all obscurations of karma will be exhausted. They will not die an untimely death. In this very life they will experience happiness: joy through sons, joy through a wife, joy through one's home, joy through a kingdom, and all aspirations will be completely fulfilled."

Then the bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi addressed the Blessed One thus: "Blessed One, I bow down before this enumeration of the Dharma. I wish also to make offerings to those who teach the Dharma, to those who copy this enumeration of the Dharma in writing, to those who uphold it, and to those who recite it. Whoever makes offerings to this enumeration of the Dharma and to those who teach the Dharma — making offerings of robes, ornaments, parasols, and vehicles — those persons make offerings to all Tathāgatas. Blessed One, they thereby make the supreme offering to me and to all bodhisattvas as well. I shall protect all those kingdoms. I shall fulfill all aspirations. I shall cause all kingdoms to receive offerings. Blessed One, for the sake of those who hear the Dharma, I wish also to bestow the words of the dhāraṇī mantra. I shall fulfill all aspirations. I shall hold them in my heart."

The Blessed One declared: "O son of noble family, speak, for the sake of sentient beings."

Then the bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi spoke these words of the dhāraṇī mantra:

Namaḥ sarvatathāgatānāṃ. Namo Amitābhāya Tathāgatāya. Namaḥ sarvabuddhabodhisattvānāṃ. Namaḥ sarva mahāradhikebhyaḥ. Tadyathā: hu hu he he, mati mati, mahāmati, vajramati, dṛḍhavajramati.

tathāgata anupārite, sara sara, ayomukhi bhrīkuṭi, bhrīkuṭamukhi, kṛpe kṛpāmukhi, satyavacana, manusmara, bhagavān Vajrapāṇi, sarvakarma

āvaraṇāni kṣāpaya, sarvāśayaparipūraya, dehi me varama, buddhasatyena, bodhisattvasatyena svāhā.

Blessed One, whoever seeks the bodhisattva grounds, or wishes to behold a Tathāgata, or to be born in a buddha-field, or desires a kingdom, or wealth and enjoyment, or territories, or riches, or grain — such a person shall honor with great offerings both this Dharma teaching and the one who proclaims the Dharma. And whoever copies, holds, or recites it shall likewise make offerings of incense, garlands of flowers, unguents, bedding, seats, garments, ornaments, parasols, and conveyances. Blessed One, such a person I shall protect. I shall cause them to receive the highest veneration in all kingdoms. I shall gladden their heart and mind according to their wishes. I shall nurture them as an only child.

Whoever wishes to behold me, or to become a wheel-turning monarch through power, or to attain meditative absorption, or to retain what is heard, or to have their elements brought to full maturation, or to render their body invisible, or wishes to travel through the sky — such a person shall undertake the fast of the eighth day of the waxing moon, day and night, and shall make an image: an image of Vajrapāṇi of golden-yellow color, adorned with all ornaments, with a serene countenance and possessing a reliquary body. In the center shall be placed the Tathāgata Śākyamuni. To the right shall be placed the noble Avalokiteśvara, four-armed, adorned with all ornaments, likewise possessing a reliquary body. To the left and right shall be placed the Four Great Kings making offerings.

The son of good family who performs this practice shall maintain cleanliness, bathe three times a day, and change garments three times a day. He shall cultivate a mind of loving-kindness toward all sentient beings. Beginning from the eighth day of the waxing moon until the fifteenth day of the following month of Māgha, he shall take as his food a gruel of rice with milk, and shall recite the mantra three times daily. As incense he shall offer agaru, sandalwood, camphor, and gugul. He shall recite up to three hundred thousand times — this constitutes the preliminary approach. At a stūpa that contains relics, or at a hermitage, he shall also make offerings of incense, burnt offerings, various flowers, and various banners. He shall also present white flour effigies to the deities. He shall also have this Dharma teaching written out and offer it along with garments, ornaments, robes, parasols, and conveyances of various kinds.

Then, until the fifteenth of the month of Māgha, he shall be endowed with a mind of compassion toward all sentient beings, bathe three times daily, change garments three times daily, and spread a square maṇḍala smeared with cow dung, covered with various flowers. He shall place sixteen full vases and sixteen lamps, and adorn that place with parasols, victory banners, and various streamers. He shall prepare a great elaborate offering cake made with various flavors, and sprinkle the area with perfumed water repeatedly, and shall continue the recitation until the image moves, the earth shakes, and he himself becomes joyful. Thereafter he shall know with certainty that this will be accomplished. After that, I shall instruct him in his dreams and speak to him auspicious words.

I shall fulfill all wishes completely. I shall care for him as though he were my only child. I shall grant whatever he, the noble one, desires — with this single exception: one who has no faith in this enumeration of the Dharma and who abandons it.

The Blessed One declared: "Vajrapāṇi, you have spoken those words well. Excellent! Excellent!"

Then the noble bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara spoke these words to the bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi: "Son of good family, this enumeration of the Dharma will not be practiced in the domain of those sentient beings who have little merit. Those sentient beings who have little merit will be unable to write it out, cause it to be written, hold it, or recite it — for māra will create obstacles for them. Son of good family, these four are the works of māra with respect to writing, reciting, and causing others to hear this enumeration of the Dharma. What are the four? They are: laziness, lack of faith, showing no respect to one's teacher, and an unsteady mind with regard to teaching the Dharma. Son of good family, one should recognize these as the work of māra.

"Furthermore, there are four other works of māra. What are the four? They are: having no interest in a spiritual friend (kalyāṇamitra), failing to take things to mind, speaking arrogant words, and thinking in this way about the present world: 'In this world there is nothing to fear. In the world beyond there is nothing to fear either. There is no karmic maturation of evil deeds. There is nothing unclear in my speech. My mind is not dull. I am handsome. I am endowed with power and authority' — and thereupon becoming attached to home and family. Those who think in such ways will experience suffering for many eons. Those four should be regarded as their unwholesome companions.

"Furthermore, there are four other works of māra. What are the four? They are: craving for wealth — by which those people will experience suffering for many eons — keeping company and conversing with unwholesome companions, taking delight in the pleasure of one's wife, and turning away the inclination of those who wish to hear the Dharma. This is how it happens: one approaches ministers and their assembled retinues and says, 'There is no karmic maturation of generosity. This Dharma teacher is a wrongdoer, intoxicated with the arrogance of power, engaging in sexual misconduct, fond of slander. He wants to create obstacles to your very life. Yet you dwell in the Dharma — you have made much of the Dharma. You are one who recites and causes sūtras to be written.' In this way one slanders, and through such talk those people will not cause this sūtra to be written out or venerated. For them many obstacles will arise in this very life, and in the next life they will be cooked in hell. Son of good family, one should recognize this as the work of māra and should not come under its power."

The Blessed One declared: "Friends, I have urged you two and three times with words: be heedful! Lest you come to regret it when you are later being cooked in the hells."

Then at that time the Blessed One spoke these verses:

I have taught many king-like sūtras
and established many sentient beings in awakening.
I have also taught the way of the buddhas.
Having heard this, be heedful!

In a later time, when you utterly decline,
you will go, falling into wrong paths.
Whoever always has faith in this sūtra —
that one is truly my own child.

Whoever always makes offerings to this sūtra
will be reborn in the buddha fields.

Wherever this king among sūtras abides,
no elemental spirits, yakṣas, rākṣasas,
hungry ghosts, kumbhāṇḍas, great serpents,
or malevolent conjurers can gain power over that place.
All wishes there will be completely fulfilled,
and one will joyfully awaken to awakening.

At that moment, upon hearing these verses from the four Great Kings, tears welled up in their eyes through the power of the Dharma, and their bodies trembled. They touched their heads to the feet of the Blessed One and addressed him thus:

Blessed One, we four Great Kings shall make offerings to those who teach this Dharma, and we shall likewise protect those who listen to it. Blessed One, whoever writes down this enumeration of Dharma, or has it written, or holds it, recites it, masters it fully, or teaches it — we shall make offerings to that one with robes and ornaments. We shall protect whoever does so. We shall thoroughly watch over their region. We shall provide them with all wealth and grain. We shall cherish them as an only child. In every battle we shall go before them. In every royal domain we shall cause them to be held in highest honour. In this way we shall repay the Tathāgata's kindness, and we will not fail to repay it. Blessed One, whoever hears this enumeration of Dharma and does not make offerings to it, and does not make offerings to those who teach it — toward such a one our hearts shall be uneasy.

Then the Blessed One gave his approval to those four Great Kings, saying: Excellent! Excellent, O Great Kings! You have done well. Always continue to act in just this way.

Then Dhṛtarāṣṭra, the great lord of the gandharvas (celestial musicians) and guardian of the realm, touched his head to the feet of the Blessed One and addressed him thus:

Blessed One, in a later time and a later age, sentient beings will appear who engage in non-virtue and who lack faith in the Tathāgata and have not entered into it. Such beings will not hold an enumeration of Dharma such as this, will not recite it, will not have it written, will not give gifts, will not trust in the ripening fruit of generosity, and will look only to pleasures of this present world. It is for the sake of sentient beings such as these that this great king among sūtras, equal to the Tathāgata himself, was taught.

The Blessed One then declared: Son of good family, two things cause sentient beings to fall into the hells: desire and aversion. These two things cause sentient beings to fall into the hells. Son of good family, four things cause sentient beings to go to a happy destiny. What are the four? They are as follows: an equanimous mind toward all sentient beings, completely pure intention, giving away all one's possessions, and abiding in pure conduct (brahmacarya).

Then the Blessed One at that time spoke these verses:

The great gift of the Great Kings is of mighty supernatural power.
It brings complete liberation from all states of misfortune and woe.
Deluded sentient beings are ever attached to desire —
intoxicated by that attachment in its hundred different forms.
They do not place faith in this sūtra,
nor give gifts within the Buddha's teaching.
Such sentient beings, born in the lower realms,
will experience feelings of suffering there.
It is for the benefit of just such sentient beings
that this sūtra of great power was taught.
Whoever always has faith in this sūtra —
for that one there is no destroyer, no evildoer.

For that king there is no evildoer, no spirit, no great serpent, no assailant.
The merit of asking well, of listening, of making offerings,
and of holding this teaching well —
that merit is praised by the wisdom of the buddhas,
and all sentient beings could not fully recount it through many ages.

Those who always remember the awakening of the buddhas and make offerings to them —
and those others who, from this very sūtra,
write even a single letter well —
the former merit cannot approach even a hundredth or a thousandth part
of the merit belonging to the latter.

Then the great bodhisattva, the noble Avalokiteśvara, addressed the Blessed One with these words:

"Blessed One, whatever son of good family or daughter of good family has faith in this enumeration of Dharma and makes manifest offerings of flowers, incense, perfume, garland of flowers, ointment, parasols, victory banners, and pennants; and who teaches the Dharma; and who makes great offerings to those who ask and those who hold it — such persons will obtain in this very life many qualities and benefits. Diseases of the eye, of the ear, of the nose, of the tongue, fever, poison, weapons, and fire will not be able to harm their bodies. For them there will arise gladness of heart from their parents, gladness of heart from their sons and wives, and gladness of heart within their homes. In all battles they will be victorious. And at the time of death, the Tathāgata

Akṣobhya will give them true solace, saying: 'Come here, O person. Go to the world-system Sukhāvatī. You are a great being, endowed with blazing roots of virtue, and you will be born in whatever abode you desire.'

Then the bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara addressed the Blessed One again with these words:

"Excellent, Blessed One! Excellent! That the Tathāgata has placed this in Jambudvīpa is itself the activity of a Tathāgata. Blessed One, this great vidyā-mantra purifies all karma."

The Blessed One declared: "Son of good family, this will not circulate in the domain of beings of little merit. Beings of little merit will not hear it; it will not come to their hands. If by the power of the buddhas it comes to someone's hand, or if a Tathāgata causes it to be heard, that person, the very moment they have heard it, should write it down, have it transcribed in letters, and read it aloud. Son of good family, even hearing merely the name of this enumeration of Dharma, which is like a Tathāgata, one will not be terrified by the lower realms. If anyone causes even a single syllable or merely the name from this enumeration of Dharma to be heard, or recites it in some direction or in some land, that person should be regarded as like a Tathāgata, venerated as if he were a Tathāgata himself, and regarded as like a parent.

Son of good family, this enumeration of Dharma was spoken by the seven Tathāgatas. All bodhisattvas rejoice in it. All gods have taken it up and guarded it completely. This enumeration of Dharma is like a parent to all bodhisattvas."

Then the bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi addressed the Blessed One with these words:

"Blessed One, in the last days and the last age, where will this enumeration of Dharma continuously, without interruption, be found in its entirety?"

The Blessed One declared: "Son of good family, this enumeration of Dharma will be found in its entirety in the abode of the nāga kings in the ocean, and in the abode of the gods of the Thirty-Three."

It will also be practiced in the southern regions. In Jambudvīpa it will remain only to a small degree — in some places it will be found, and in others it will not be practiced.

Then the Blessed One spoke these words to the bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi: "Vajrapāṇi, I entrust this enumeration of Dharma to you, so that it may be upheld, recited, venerated, and caused to be heard. Should this enumeration

of Dharma, which is equal to a Tathāgata, ever decline, that would be the work of the Tathāgata. Preserve it."

Then the bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi spoke these words to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, I will uphold this enumeration of Dharma so that it may be upheld, recited, venerated, and caused to be heard. I will also venerate and honor those who teach the Dharma. Whoever venerates this enumeration of Dharma and those who teach it thereby venerates me as well. I will protect and fully guard it, and in so doing I shall repay the kindness of the Tathāgata."

Then the Blessed One uttered words of praise to the bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi, saying: "Excellent! Excellent, Vajrapāṇi! Do exactly as you have said."

Then the noble bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara spoke these words to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, I pay homage to this enumeration of Dharma. I will also pay the highest honor to those who hear the Dharma, those who write it down, those who uphold it, those who read it, those who cause it to be heard, and those who recite scripture.

"Blessed One, if this enumeration of Dharma were to appear in a land of beings of little merit, or if it were to appear and be practiced in a land whose king does not accord with the Dharma — and that king were to neither venerate nor have faith in this enumeration of Dharma, and were to neither venerate those who teach the Dharma, those who write it down, those who uphold it, those who read it, those who cause it to be heard, and those who recite scripture, nor cultivate toward them the perception of them as a teacher — then this enumeration of Dharma would decline in that land. Many unwholesome phenomena and many afflictions of mind would arise there. Therefore I shall urge that king of the warrior class to reflect: 'The Dharma has declined in my land.' And through that, he will practice the Dharma."

The Blessed One declared: "Excellent! Excellent, son of good family! That is just so. Son of good family, consider this analogy. Suppose some faithful son of good family or daughter of good family were to venerate as many Tathāgatas — arhats, perfectly and completely awakened buddhas — as there are grains of sand in the Ganges river, honoring them with the highest veneration for a hundred or a thousand years, and were to fill this Jambudvīpa entirely with precious jewels and give them as gifts to śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas, and were to give away their own self, their spouse, their sons and daughters — and suppose another were to venerate this enumeration of Dharma, or write it down, or have it written, or read it, or offer it flowers, incense, perfume, and

garlands of flowers, and were to give even a single eighth portion of a bowl of yogurt for the sake of this enumeration of Dharma — that person would generate far more merit. The earlier root of virtue would not amount to even a hundredth part of it. And whoever, having cultivated the perception of a teacher, were to honor this enumeration of Dharma with parasols, victory banners, and —

— with victory banners and pennants, and who would give even a patch of land the size of a bull's hoofprint as a robe, an ornament, a parasol, a mount, a village, a town, or a piece of ground for the sake of this enumeration of Dharma — and who, moreover, knows that this body is without essence, like a dream, like an illusion, like a bubble on water, understanding that this body has no essence, and understanding that all phenomena are impermanent: that person has surely been prophesied by the Tathāgata. They have surely been encouraged by the Tathāgata. They venerate all the Tathāgatas. And in the future, in due course, they will fully and perfectly awaken to unsurpassed, complete, perfect awakening.

At that moment, all the bodhisattvas, and the lords of the gods (Śakra and the divine kings), and the lords of the nāgas, and the lords of the yakṣas, and the lords of the asuras, and the lords of the garuḍas, and the lords of the humans and nonhumans, with one voice said to the Blessed One: "Excellent!" — "Blessed One, excellent, excellent! This is the wheel of Dharma turned for the second time. We, too, in full accord, will venerate this enumeration of Dharma, will protect that land, will venerate that teacher of Dharma, will guard them, will prophesy for them, and will encourage them. Whoever teaches this Dharma, or writes it down, or holds it, or reads it — toward them we will cultivate the perception of a teacher, the perception of a father, the perception of a child. And we too will cultivate the perception of a father toward them. If anyone were to do harm to this enumeration of Dharma, then in all their lands their children, servants, and parents will become unhappy, and afterward that person will be born in hell."

Then the Blessed One said "Excellent!" to those bodhisattvas and to all from the lords of the gods down to the lords of humans: "Well done, well done, friends! Do it exactly so. I entrust this to you — to have this enumeration of Dharma heard and venerated. How sad that this enumeration of Dharma, which resembles the Tathāgata himself, may soon disappear, that some may abandon it and fall into hell. This enumeration of Dharma brings benefit to the many, brings happiness to the many. And lest you come to regret it later —

when this enumeration of Dharma was taught, this great earth shook and trembled greatly. Six thousand living beings were liberated from all outflows without clinging, their minds completely freed."

Then the noble bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara addressed the Blessed One thus: "Blessed One, however much merit would be generated by a son or daughter of good family who writes down this enumeration of Dharma, commissions it to be written, holds it, reads it, masters it thoroughly, teaches it fully and correctly to others, and venerates it with flowers, incense, perfume, garlands of flowers, ointments, powders, robes, parasols, victory banners, and pennants — where, Blessed One, will such a person be reborn?"

Then the Blessed One said "Excellent!" to the noble bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara: "Well done, well done, son of good family! It is excellent that you have asked the Tathāgata this."

"Therefore, son of good family, listen well and hold this in mind, for I shall explain it to you. Whatever son or daughter of good family writes down this enumeration of Dharma, commissions it to be written, holds it, reads it, masters it thoroughly, teaches it fully and correctly to others, and venerates it with flowers, incense, perfume, garlands of flowers, ointments, powders, robes, parasols, victory banners, and pennants — that person, upon passing away from here, will be reborn in the world-realm of Sukhāvatī.

Son of good family, one who fills this great trichiliocosm entirely with precious gems and gives them as gifts to śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas — that merit is far surpassed by the merit of the son or daughter of good family who holds this enumeration of Dharma, venerates it, writes it down, commissions it to be written, and teaches the Dharma, venerating those who do so with flowers, incense, perfume, garlands of flowers, ointments, and the like. The former has not accumulated merit equal to that.

Furthermore, son of good family, one who practices the conduct of a bodhisattva and gives away sons, daughters, and spouse, gives away hands, feet, eyes, and head — even that is surpassed by the merit of one who writes down this enumeration of Dharma, commissions it to be written, reads it, or places faith in it. That merit grows far more abundantly, son of good family, and the former has not accumulated merit equal to that.

That son of good family who teaches the Dharma should be regarded as none other than the equal of a Tathāgata, and veneration should be openly performed for him as one equal to a Tathāgata."

Then the noble bodhisattva mahāsattva Avalokiteśvara addressed the Blessed One in these words: "Blessed One, this enumeration of Dharma is worthy of veneration by the world of gods, humans, and asuras. And one who teaches the Dharma from it is likewise worthy of veneration and homage. Blessed One, this enumeration of Dharma is of great miraculous power. Therefore a faithful son or daughter of good family should listen to this enumeration of Dharma with reverence. They should attend to it with reverence and hold it in mind. Blessed One, whatever region this enumeration of Dharma is practiced in — that region is blessed by the Tathāgata. That region should be regarded as a stūpa. That region is a place worthy of veneration by the world of gods, humans, and asuras."

The Blessed One declared: "So it is, son of good family, so it is. Son of good family, that region is indeed a place worthy of veneration by the world of gods, humans, and asuras."

Then the noble bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara again addressed the Blessed One: "Blessed One, if someone makes offerings to this enumeration of Dharma, and with a mind devoted to its veneration and honor gives even so little as a single mustard seed in offering — all five acts of immediate retribution (ānantaryakarman) accumulated by that person will be completely exhausted. For ninety thousand aeons they will be reborn in families of great wealth and enjoyment. For eighty thousand aeons they will become wheel-turning kings (cakravartins). They will be reborn in the pure buddha-fields. They will not perish in an evil state of existence."

They will not be reborn in an evil state of existence. All their aspirations will be completely fulfilled.

Then the Blessed One spoke these words to the bodhisattva, the great being, the noble Avalokiteśvara: "Son of good family, in a past age, at a time beyond countable aeons, there appeared a Tathāgata named Royal Crest of Boundless Dharma-Wisdom (jñāna), Free from Attachment, Unstained by Dust. At that time, in the form of a brahmin, I heard this enumeration of Dharma. Having heard it, I then taught it to sentient beings. In that very moment of receiving it, I attained acceptance of the Dharma, and the pure eye of Dharma for all phenomena became clear within me. All those sentient beings who heard it were fully liberated from every evil state of existence and would never again be reborn in an evil state. The pure eye of Dharma for all phenomena became clear in them, and every one of those sentient beings at last fully and perfectly

awoke to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening. They did fully and perfectly awake.

"Son of good family, for many years, for many hundreds of years, for many thousands of years, for many hundreds of thousands of years, on behalf of sentient beings bound by attachment, aversion, and delusion, I gave away wealth, grain, travelers' provisions, and gold. In the end I gave away even my hands, my feet, my eyes, my head, my beloved sons, my wives, my daughters. I gave away my limbs and my bones. I gave away my house, my village, my city, my town, my country, and my royal palace. For many hundreds of thousands of years I also practiced the holy life of celibacy. I did not associate with householders. I took no delight in kingship, no delight in wealth, no delight in country or the circle of the palace, no delight in sons and daughters, no delight in a wife. Resolutely and without exception I abided in the holy life of celibacy. Resolutely and without exception I gave gifts. Resolutely and without exception I made offerings to the buddhas, the Dharma, and the Saṅgha, and paid them homage. Resolutely and without exception I honored, revered, depicted in paintings, and made offerings to those who taught the Dharma, with flowers, incense, perfume, garlands, ointments, powders, robes, parasols, victory banners, and pennants. I also served and paid homage to many spiritual friends. Yet even so, out of disenchantment with saṃsāra I gave away my bodies. I gave away my eyes, my own flesh, my limbs and bones, and even my own skin — to say nothing of other external possessions. Not once did I feel regret.

"Then all those bodhisattvas, the lords of the gods, the lords of the nāgas, the lords of the yakṣas, the lords of the asuras, the lords of humans, the wanderers, the wandering mendicants, and the naked ascetics, upon hearing this account of the Tathāgata's former conduct, were moved to tears by the power of the Dharma, and every one of them attained acceptance of the Dharma."

The Blessed One then declared: "Friends, hold fast to this enumeration of Dharma. It performs the Tathāgata's work for sentient beings."

Then the bodhisattva noble Avalokiteśvara addressed the Blessed One: "Blessed One, those sentient beings who have faith in this enumeration of Dharma, make offerings to it, hold it, read it aloud, and bring it to full mastery — they are rare indeed. Those in whose presence it resides are to be regarded as like the appearance of a buddha."

The Blessed One declared: "Excellent! Excellent, son of good family!

Son of good family, it is just so. Those sons or daughters of good family who make offerings to this enumeration of Dharma, who copy it in writing, who have it copied in writing, who hold it, read it aloud, and teach the Dharma — those who make offerings to them with flowers, incense, perfume, garlands, unguents, powders, robes, parasols, victory banners, and pennants are truly rare. Those who do so are to be regarded as nothing other than the likeness of a Tathāgata.

Son of good family, those sentient beings who make no offerings to this enumeration of Dharma, who do not hold it, do not read it aloud, and do not give it away — such beings will wander in saṃsāra for many eons, for hundreds of eons, for thousands of eons, and will experience a great multitude of sufferings, hundreds upon hundreds of sufferings.

Consider this analogy. Suppose there is a pregnant woman. When the child growing in her womb has become either a boy or a girl, and has reached the age of one month, two months, three months, five months, or a full term — for all that time the woman's body is pressed down and oppressed. Her joints spread apart, her belly swells, the capacity of her voice grows faint. Her body, thoroughly wrung by those feelings, endures the feeling of suffering all that while, even as she maintains her life. Until the moment of giving birth, she experiences the suffering of a hell-being. She thinks to herself: when my child has been born, if I come through the birth safely, I shall lead a life of celibacy. But afterwards, when she again becomes seized by the attachment of sensual desire, she no longer remembers those sufferings and instead gives rise to a perception of pleasure and ease.

In the same way, the sentient beings who will arise in future times and future ages will place no faith in this enumeration of Dharma, make no offerings to it, do not hold it, and do not read it aloud. They will be born in the hells, in the realms of animals, and in the world of Yama, the Lord of Death. Intoxicated by attachment, they endure those same feelings, thinking: we must maintain the household, the servants, the wife, the sons, the daughters. But when at last they are born in a hell realm, they are filled with regret. And when they are eventually released and freed from there, being once again seized by attachment they forget the suffering of the hell realm, cease to practice generosity, and no longer guard their ethical conduct.

Consider this further analogy. A man drinks alcohol, becomes thoroughly drunk, extremely drunk and incoherent. In that state his mind cannot seek out his home, cannot find the path; he has no perception of father, mother, wife, sons, or daughters; he no longer remembers the Buddha, the Dharma, or the Saṅgha. Through the force of his drunkenness, even if he should be sitting in a charnel ground, he feels no fear, and thinks: who among gods, nāgas, or yakṣas could there be that might frighten me? He takes pleasure and rest on a bed of donkey dung, wood, grass, or thorns. His body is racked and drunk with intoxication. But when he sobers up and regains his senses, he is overcome with remorse, thinking: even at the cost of my life, I should never have drunk this alcohol.

In just the same way, sentient beings intoxicated and maddened by the drunkenness of attachment, those householders who wander in delusion with minds besotted by wealth, do not seek out the Buddha, the Dharma, or the Saṅgha at all. They do not even think of generosity. They do not seek rebirth in the higher realms, or becoming a king, or birth in a buddha-field. Instead they continue to revolve within that very saṃsāra, and come to experience the suffering of birth in the hells, in the realm of animals, and in the world of Yama, the Lord of Death. They hold the thought: my body is comfortable; there is no suffering here.

When, after traversing a path one-in-a-hundred, they are finally freed from those hells, from the realm of animals, and from the world of Yama, and manage to obtain a human body, then while dwelling in the womb, their body is utterly compressed and afflicted by darkness, tormented in that body by phlegm, bile, mucus, blood, and the absorbed nourishment from outside. Dwelling thus, they think: for a hundred years, or for a kalpa, or for a hundred kalpas, or a thousand kalpas, or a hundred thousand kalpas, we have revolved in saṃsāra and experienced unbearable and disagreeable sensations of suffering, and nowhere have we had any refuge. Whose karmic maturation is this? We ourselves have in the past committed many misdeeds. In this way, dwelling in the womb, they generate a remorse like that of beings in hell. They think: when we are freed from this hell of dwelling in the womb, we shall strive and seek with unwavering faith in the Buddha, the Dharma, and the Saṅgha, and by every means ensure that we never again remain in this hell of the womb.

Yet afterward, once they have escaped from the womb, they become heedless, and so they come once more to experience suffering in the hells.

Therefore one must never be heedless, not even for a moment.

Then the venerable Ānanda addressed the Blessed One and said: Blessed One, what is the name of this enumeration of Dharma teachings? And how should we take it up?

The Blessed One declared: Ānanda, therefore take up this enumeration of Dharma teachings under the name "That Which Provides Refuge to All Sentient Beings." Take it up also under the name "That Which Was Requested by the Bodhisattva." Take it up also under the name "The King of Magnificent Emanations of the Arrayed King." Take it up also under the name "The Tathāgata Who Has Fully and Perfectly Attained Awakening." Take it up also under the name "The King Who Arrays the Qualities of All Phenomena."

When the Blessed One had spoken these words, all those bodhisattvas and those great śrāvakas, Śakra (Indra, king of the gods), Brahmā, all those world-guardians, all those who formed the complete assembly, gods and humans, asuras, and gandharvas — the entire world rejoiced and wholeheartedly praised what the Blessed One had taught.

The noble Mahāyāna sūtra entitled The King Who Arrays the Qualities of All Phenomena is complete.

This was translated by the Indian master Prajñāvarman and Surendrabodhi, together with the chief editor-translator, the monk Ye shes sde, and others.

Translator's Notes

- The compound name Sarvadharmaguṇavyūharāja follows the standard colophon convention of giving the Sanskrit title first, then the Tibetan. The Sanskrit is preserved exactly as transliterated in the Tibetan.

The phrase rendered "sought only the kind of discourse that relates to the Tathāgata's teaching" translates de bzhin gshegs pa'i chos kyi 'bel ba'i gdam 'dri ba sha stag, where sha stag is an emphatic particle meaning "exclusively" or "only," and 'bel ba'i gdam refers to extended, connected discourse pertaining to the Dharma.

The passage ends mid-sentence in the source text, so the translation likewise ends open.

- The bodhisattva name བྱུ་ཤར་རྒྱལ་པོ་ is rendered throughout as Vyūharāja, the standard Sanskrit back-formation meaning "King of Arrangements" or "King of Arrays," which also appears as the sūtra title at the close of the passage. The final line functions as a colophon-style title statement rather than narrative, identifying the text by name.

The phrase རྩོམ་པ་ལྔ་ལྔ་ལྔ་ལྔ་ལྔ་ (wanderers and roaming ones) likely refers to various classes of non-human or semi-divine wandering beings; the rendering is approximate since the precise referents in this context are not entirely certain.

- The name of the Tathāgata rendered as Vidyutprabhā (Tibetan: glog snang ba) literally

means "one whose light is like lightning" or "lightning-luminous." This is a proper name and is kept in Sanskrit reconstruction.

The term rendered "wanderers" (Tibetan: kun tu rgyu) corresponds to the Sanskrit parivrājaka, a category of non-Buddhist mendicant wanderers often grouped with tīrthikas in such lists.

The phrase rendered "boiled in the hells" is the literal sense of the Tibetan (btsob bar 'gyur), referring to the torments of the hot hells.

- The phrase rendered "performs the service of attending upon a Tathāgata as a preceptor" translates a construction meaning to act as a personal attendant or pupil-servant to the Tathāgata in the manner of a preceptor-disciple relationship; the exact nuance is contextually determined and some ambiguity remains as to whether "preceptor" qualifies the Tathāgata or the mode of service. The passage ends mid-speech as the Tibetan breaks off; the translation faithfully reflects this.

- The term rendered "Melody of the Victor" translates the Tathāgata's name Rgyal ba'i dbyangs, a likely rendering of a Sanskrit name such as Jinasvara or Jitaghōṣa; the exact Sanskrit original is uncertain.

The phrase translated "comparable to the father and mother of all Tathāgatas" renders yab yum dang 'dra ba'i, which literally invokes the "father-mother" relationship, the standard classical metaphor for a text or dhāraṇī that is the source and nourishment of all buddhas — here used in a non-tantric, honorific sense meaning the dhāraṇī is the supreme progenitor-like Dharma.

- The phrase rendered "reliquary body" translates a term used to describe images that contain or are associated with relics; it indicates a consecrated image housing sacred remains, and distinguishes these figures from purely symbolic representations.

The month name "Māgha" is inferred from the Tibetan "nyaba," a lunar month designation; this identification is conventional in the Indo-Tibetan ritual context and carries moderate uncertainty. The Tibetan reads simply "the following month" paired with "the fifteenth day," and the commentarial tradition typically identifies this as Māgha.

The phrase rendered "white flour effigies to the deities" refers to tormā-like ritual cake offerings made of white flour; the pairing of "lha bshos" (divine effigies or deity-cakes) with "dkarba" (white) is standard ritual terminology.

- The phrase rendered "causing others to hear" translates a causative construction meaning to have someone listen or to introduce someone to the text; the fourfold structure here enumerates activities related to propagating the text that māra obstructs.

The passage where someone approaches ministers and slanders the Dharma teacher is syntactically compressed in the Tibetan. The slanders listed — wrongdoing, arrogance, misconduct, fondness for tale-bearing — are all attributed to the Dharma teacher by the māra-influenced speaker, not asserted by the text itself.

- The term kumbhāṇḍa is left in Sanskrit as it is a class of spirit beings with no satisfactory English equivalent; in Tibetan it appears as ཀུམབ་ཀླུ་པ་ (grulbum), rendered in classical sources as pot-bellied spirits.

Dhṛtarāṣṭra is identified here by his Tibetan epithet རྒྱལ་པོ་ལྷ་མོ་, "Guardian of the Realm," and as lord of the gandharvas; he is one of the four Great Kings and guardian of the East. The rendering "great lord of the gandharvas" reflects his standard iconographic and textual role.

- The phrase rendered "the Tathāgata Akṣobhya will give them true solace" translates "de bzhin gshegs pa mi 'khrugs pas yang dag par dbugs 'byin par mdzad." The Tibetan name mi 'khrugs pa is the standard rendering of Akṣobhya, "the Imperturbable." The passage describes

a deathbed vision in which Akṣobhya appears and directs the dying person to Sukhāvātī, which is unusual given that Akṣobhya's own pure land is Abhirati. This theological tension is present in the Tibetan source and is not resolved here.

- The passage breaks off mid-sentence with "parasols, victory banners, and —" reflecting the abrupt end of the supplied Tibetan input; the translation follows the source text as given.

The phrase rendered "a single eighth portion of a bowl of yogurt" (एकैकं भागं दध्निः) is a standard Indic idiom for the smallest imaginable offering — literally one eighth of a bowl of curd or yogurt — used to contrast minimal material giving with the vast merit of Dharma veneration.

- The phrase rendered "lords of the garuḍas" translates nam mkha' lding gi dbang po, literally "lords of the sky-soaring ones" — nam mkha' lding being the Tibetan for garuḍa (Skt. garuḍa), the great mythic birds. This is standard in such cosmological lists.

The passage "Do it exactly so" and the warning that follows have a slightly elliptical syntax in the Tibetan; the translation follows the most contextually coherent reading, in which the Blessed One both endorses the assembly's pledge and adds his own admonition about the text's imminent decline and the consequences of abandoning it.

- The five acts of immediate retribution, rendered here as "five acts of immediate retribution (ānantaryakarman)," refers to the five heinous deeds that in Abhidharma doctrine lead directly to rebirth in the lowest hell without any intervening existence: patricide, matricide, killing an arhat, wounding a Tathāgata, and causing a schism in the Saṅgha. This is a standard doctrinal reference.
- The phrase rendered "wanderers" and "wandering mendicants" translates two distinct Indic categories of religious wanderers: the first likely corresponds to parivrājakas (non-Buddhist ascetic wanderers) and the second to perhaps similar figures. The Tibetan reads spyod pa pa and kun tu rgyu, both of which denote types of wandering ascetics; the precise distinction between them here is not entirely certain, though the general sense is clear.

The epithet of the Tathagata — rendered "Royal Crest of Boundless Dharma-Wisdom, Free from Attachment, Unstained by Dust" — is a translation of the Tibetan name chos kyi ye shes mtha' yas pa chags pa med cing rdul dang bral ba'i rgyal po'i tog. This is a single proper name and has been rendered descriptively in keeping with TTS requirements.

- The phrase rendered as "the world of Yama, the Lord of Death" translates a term literally meaning "Yama's world," referring to the realm governed by the death-lord Yama, here functioning as a general term for the lower destinies overseen by that figure, distinct from the hot and cold hells proper. The three destinations listed — hells, animals, and Yama's world — are a somewhat unusual triad; more commonly one finds hells, animals, and hungry ghosts. It is possible that Yama's world here encompasses the preta realm, as is attested in some Indian sources.
- The phrase rendered "traversing a path one-in-a-hundred" translates a Tibetan idiom suggesting the extreme rarity of attaining a human birth after release from the lower realms — literally "one in a hundred paths." The sense is that human rebirth is achieved only after an overwhelmingly difficult journey through many rebirths.

The closing colophon names three translators: the Indian paṇḍita Prajñāvarman, the Indian paṇḍita Surendrabodhi, and the Tibetan chief editor-translator Ye shes sde, the standard imperial-period translation team associated with numerous canonical texts.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.